



Class Notes

Heaven and Earth

Genesis 1

Dr. Tim Mackie

Explore Genesis 1-11, the Psalms, and the biblical wisdom literature to understand how the biblical authors understood Heaven and Earth. This context will give richer meaning to Jesus' words about the new creation.

Last updated on: October 8, 2024

Table of Contents

Module 1: The Meaning of Heaven and Earth

[Session 1: Our Place in the Universe](#)

[Session 2: The Words “Heavens” and “Earth” in the Hebrew Bible](#)

[Session 3: Heaven and Earth Come Together in Jesus](#)

[Session 4: Reflections on Heaven and Earth in the New Testament](#)

[Session 5: Scripture, Communication, Language, and Culture](#)

Module 2: Genesis 1 in Its Ancient Context

[Session 6: Genesis 1 Is an Ancient Israelite Cosmology](#)

[Session 7: The Purpose of Light on Day One](#)

[Session 8: Ancient Egyptian Cosmology](#)

[Session 9: Ancient Babylonian Cosmology](#)

[Session 10: The Beginning and Nothingness](#)

[Session 11: Genesis 1 Imagery in Jeremiah 4](#)

[Session 12: Genesis 1 Imagery in Psalm 104](#)

Module 3: The Literary Design of Genesis 1

[Session 13: The Structure and Message of Genesis 1](#)

[Session 14: Repeated Words in Genesis 1](#)

[Session 15: Relationships Between Days](#)

Module 4: A Tour of the Cosmos

[Session 16: The Waters Above and Below](#)

[Session 17: The Dragon in the Waters](#)

[Session 18: The Dry Land](#)

[Session 19: Reflections on Where All Creation Is Headed](#)

[Session 20: Rivers of Life](#)

[Session 21: Jesus and Living Water](#)

[Session 22: Ancient Cosmology in Psalm 36](#)

Module 5: The Unity of Heaven and Earth

[Session 23: The Heavens](#)

[Session 24: Heaven and Earth United in the Temple](#)

[Session 25: Reflections on Heaven Coming to Earth](#)

[Session 26: The Rulers Above](#)

Module 6: Humans and Their Role in the Cosmos

[Session 27: The Rulers Below](#)

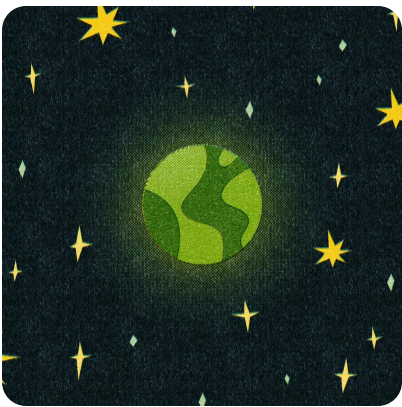
[Session 28: Humans as the Image, or Idol, of God](#)

[Session 29: The Image of God in the Storyline of the Bible](#)

Module 7: Time and Eschatology in Genesis 1

[Session 30: God Rests on the Seventh Day](#)

[Session 31: The Sabbath With No End](#)



Module 1: The Meaning of Heaven and Earth

SESSIONS 1-5

Explore the meaning of the words “Heaven” and “Earth.” Spoiler alert: Our modern views are different from those of the biblical authors. Let’s dive in.